

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

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Key epidemiologic findings on Alzheimer’s disease show consistent socioeconomic and ethnic gradients :

- Education : Lower educational attainment is associated with an increased risk of incident dementia , including Alzheimer’s . Higher education is protective , reflecting both cognitive reserve and access to health and diagnostic services . Therefore , ‘A lower level of education’ is not protective .

- Ethnicity : African Americans have a higher incidence and prevalence of Alzheimer’s disease , with approximately 63 % of all dementia cases in the US affecting African Americans . Hispanics/Latin os also have excess risk relative to non-Hispanic whites . Thus , being African or Hispanic American is not associated with a decreased risk .

- Marital status : Widow hood is strongly linked to increased risk of dementia , likely through reduced social support and monitoring . Being married is protective .

- Urban versus rural residence : Urban living is not itself a recognized protective factor , and rural residence has not been reliably shown to decrease risk once other variables are controlled .

- Family history : A first-degree family history increases an individual’s lifetime risk and age at onset , so it is not associated with decreased risk .

- Dietary fats : High intake of saturated fats has not been shown to protect against Alzheimer’s ; in fact , high-fat diets may be associated with worse cognitive outcomes in some studies .

- Age : Older age is the primary risk factor for Alzheimer’s ; older individuals have substantially higher incidence rates .

- Fish intake : omega - 3 fatty acids (especially DHA/EPA) from fish show promise for neuro protection and may lower the risk of dementia , though evidence is not uniformly protective across studies . Nonetheless , among the options , fish intake is the only factor with putative protective associations in the literature .

- Smoking and alcohol : Smoking is harmful to cardiovascular and neurologic health and is not protective ; light , regular alcohol consumption may be associated with reduced dementia risk , but the option ‘drinking alcohol regularly’ is imprecise and not the established protective factor .

Therefore , the factor associated with decreased risk is eating fish .

Correct answer : H . Eating fish

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< answer >

H . Eating fish

</answer >